※ 연수 실습용 가상 자료입니다. 실제 대학·과목·교수와 관계없습니다. (Fictional syllabus for training only)

DATA 210: Data and Society — Course Syllabus, Fall 2026

Westbrook University (fictional) · Department of Information Studies · 3 credits · Tue/Thu 10:00–11:15
Instructor: Dr. Jane Rivera (fictional) · Office hours: Wed 14:00–16:00 or by appointment

Course Description

Data shapes how we see the world, from news charts to AI recommendations. In this course, students learn to find, question, and communicate with data. There are no exams; instead, students build a portfolio of short data stories and one team project for a real community partner.

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

1. **Locate** and clean an open dataset for a stated purpose.
2. **Critique** a published chart and **redesign** it to reduce distortion.
3. **Distinguish** correlation from causation in news claims, citing evidence.
4. **Communicate** a data-based recommendation to a non-expert audience in 5 minutes.

Assessment

Component	Weight	Linked outcome
Weekly data journal (12 short entries, graded complete/incomplete)	15%	1, 3
Chart redesign challenge (×2)	20%	2
“Is it causal?” news analysis	15%	3
Team community project: proposal → draft → final report	35%	1–4
Peer review of two other teams	5%	4
Participation (in-class activities)	10%	—

Revision policy: Each student may revise and resubmit one chart redesign within one week of feedback for a higher grade.

Late work: Every student has three “grace days” to use for any assignment except the final presentation, no questions asked.

Generative AI Policy

GREEN — allowed	Brainstorming project ideas, explaining a statistics concept, checking grammar.
YELLOW — allowed with disclosure	Writing code to clean data or draw charts. Add a short note: tool name, what you asked, and what you changed.
RED — not allowed	Writing your data journal reflections or peer reviews for you.

If you are unsure, ask before you use it. Using AI is never a problem when you are open about it.

Weekly Schedule

Week	Topic	Due
1	What counts as data? Course overview	Journal 1
2–3	Finding and cleaning open data	Journal 2–3
4–5	How charts mislead	Chart redesign #1 (Week 5)
6	Community partner visit; team formation	Project proposal
7–8	Correlation, causation, and the news	“Is it causal?” analysis (Week 8)
9–10	Algorithms and prediction: who is counted?	Chart redesign #2 (Week 10)
11–13	Team project studio	Project draft (Week 12)
14	Presentations to the community partner	Peer review
15	Reflection and portfolio wrap-up	Final report

Support

Students who need learning accommodations should contact the Accessibility Office (fictional) in the first two weeks. Feedback on this course is collected anonymously in Week 6 and Week 13, and changes are shared with the class.